BHIMRAO YASHWANT AMBEDKAR
Prabuddha Republican Party candidate, Hoshiarpur, Punjab

across Maharashtra and is himself the candidate from Akola. Anandraj, his youngest brother, is shooting for the Lok Sabha from nearby Amravati, with his Republican Sena. And the middle brother, blessed with the name Bhimrao, hopes to personally plant his Prabuddha Republican Party's flag in faraway Hoshiarpur, Punjab. "We have a strong unit there.... (BSP supremo) Mayawati is on the back foot and hence the Ambedkarite movement has faced a setback in north India. I have no interest in Maharashtra politics. I want to go to other states," says the working president of the Buddhist Society of India, and commander-in-chief of volunteer force Samata Sainik Dal. Their father, Dr Ambedkar's son Yashwantrao, had run from Hoshiarpur in 1962—though in vain. This time, Punjab's fields seem a touch ripe for the picking. ■



some good old Kerala spices on the simmering gravy in the high ranges, alleging he'd paid Rs 25 lakh to Anil in 2013—when Papa Antony was DefMin in New Delhi—for having a pal appointed as CBI standing counsel in the Kerala High Court. Anil couldn't pull it off, says Dallal, but was reluctant to return the stash. So, the story goes, the broker had to request former Rajya Sabha deputy speaker P.J. Kurien to gently intervene... and the lard quietly melted back. Anil has hotly denied the charges, of course, but by now the *meenchatti* is boiling. What with Dad wishing him the worst of luck. Like father, unlike son. ■



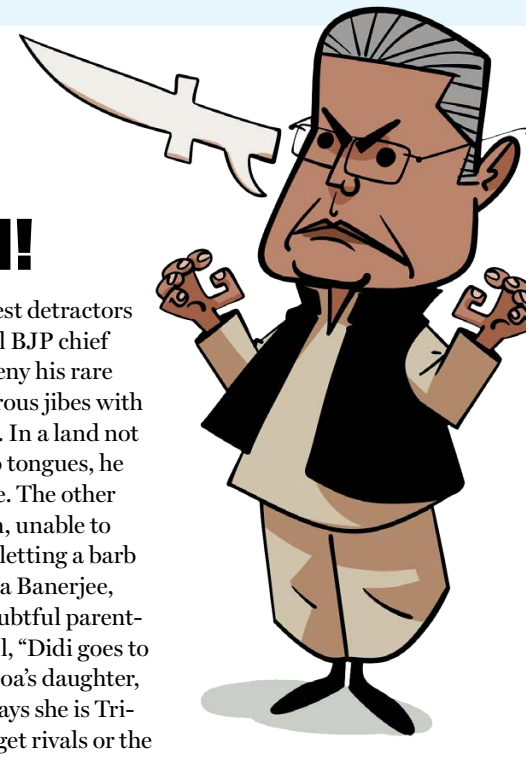
▶ TAMIL NADU

NO ENTRY

With a name like C.N. Annadurai, distant city folks may expect 'naïve tribals' to treat the DMK's incumbent MP in Tamil Nadu's Tiruvannamalai constituency as a paragon of justice, if not an outright avatar of the legendary party founder. But residents of 32 remote tribal hamlets of Pungampattu and Nellivasal Nadu, atop the Jawadhu Hills in Tirupathur district, have put up signs asking parties not to bother dropping by for electioneering. Including the CNA namesake. Reason: the 17,000-odd voters say their children still have to trek through dense forests for over 12 km if they are to study at the nearest government school. Which means, no road connectivity yet—nor the basic development markers that come in its wake. ■

▶ BENGAL

OH MY GHOSH!



Not even the biggest detractors of former Bengal BJP chief **Dilip Ghosh** would deny his rare gift for airing indecorous jibes with reassuring frequency. In a land not exactly short of sharp tongues, he still manages to shine. The other day, he was at it again, unable to control himself from letting a barb fly straight at Mamata Banerjee, saying she was of "doubtful parentage". How come? Well, "Didi goes to Goa and says she is Goa's daughter, goes to Tripura and says she is Tripura's daughter." Forget rivals or the public, even his party stays on bated breath and is often forced to snub him. That's what happened this time too, with even the EC rapping him on the knuckles. Apologies followed, though not without a parting shot to the effect that the TMC has uttered worse. The outgoing MP from Medinipur, Ghosh will be laying his polemic thick on the Bardhaman-Durgapur constituency this time. ■